

Roasted garlic-lemon tofu and broccoli

The flavors in this dish are a combination of savory with a touch of sweet and a dash of **tang**. The roasted garlic and lemon juice work beautifully together with the bite of the Tabasco and the brightness and crunch of the broccoli florets. While its flavors are rich, it's an easy dish to make.

2 heads of garlic

2 teaspoons olive oil

2 to 3 tablespoons lemon juice

1 tablespoon brown rice vinegar

Several dashes of Tabasco sauce

¼ cup vegetable stock [60ml]

½ teaspoon salt

Freshly ground pepper

¼ cup vegetable oil, for frying [60ml]

1 pound extra-firm tofu, preferably thawed frozen, pressed to remove excess water and sliced lengthwise in half [500g]

½ pound broccoli florets [250g]

1. Preheat the oven to 325°F [160°C]. **Separate** the heads of garlic into individual cloves. Skin them and cut off the hard bits on the ends. (It's okay if the cloves are slightly crushed as you get the skin off them.) Toss the garlic cloves with the olive oil to coat lightly and cook them in a covered baking dish for 30 to 40 minutes, or until lightly browned and very soft. You may toss them once or so while they are cooking.
2. In a medium bowl, **mash** the roasted garlic to a paste with a fork. Add 2 tablespoons of the lemon juice, the vinegar, Tabasco, vegetable stock, salt, and a generous grinding of pepper. Mix well.
3. In a large cast-iron skillet, **heat** the vegetable oil over medium-high heat until very hot. Fry the tofu, turning once, until lightly browned and crisp on both sides, 2 to 3 minutes. Drain the tofu on paper towels and lightly salt it. Pour out all but 1 to 2 tablespoons oil from the pan.

4. While the tofu is still warm, **cut** it into cubes and stir into the marinade. Toss until very well coated. Let marinate at room temperature for 15 minutes.
5. Heat the cast-iron skillet over high heat. **Pour** the tofu with all its marinade into the skillet. (Use a rubber spatula to scrape all the marinade out of bowl.) Cook, stirring constantly, until the marinade is completely absorbed and the tofu is well coated. I recommend preparing the tofu up to this point, where it can be set aside. Then cook the broccoli and mix it in when you are ready to eat.
6. **Steam** or blanch the broccoli until just tender, 3 to 5 minutes; drain. Reheat the tofu and marinade, if necessary. Add the broccoli and toss gently to mix. For best results, finish with a splash of lemon juice and a dash of Tabasco sauce.

SERVES 2

